

Word family: **contribute / contributes / contributed / contributing / contribution / contributor / contributory**

Base word: contribute

Part of speech: mainly **verb**

Related forms:

* **contribute** (v.) — 貢獻；出力；捐助；投稿；促成

* **contribution** (n.) — 貢獻；捐款；投稿；促成因素

* **contributor** (n.) — 貢獻者；捐助者；撰稿人；促成因素

* **contributory** (adj.) — 有促成作用的；構成部分原因的

* **contributing** (adj./participle) — 有份造成的；作出貢獻的

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **contribute to a team**

* **contribute to a project**

* **contribute ideas**

* **contribute time / effort**

* **contribute money**

* **contribute to a fund**

* **contribute to charity**

* **contribute to a result**

* **contribute to a problem**

* **contribute an article**

* **make a contribution**

* **valuable contribution**

* **financial contribution**

* **individual contribution**

* **contribution to society**

* **pension contribution**

* **contributor to a magazine**

* **contributing factor**

* **contributory factor**

Meaning in this passage

> In many teams, some employees shoulder most of the burden while others **contribute very little**.

Here, **contribute** means:

**to give relatively little work, effort, ideas, or useful input to the shared task — 貢獻；出力；

投入**

The passage contrasts employees who do most of the work with those who add very little to the team's shared result.

**中文翻譯： **

在很多團隊中，有些員工承擔了大部分重擔，而其他人卻**幾乎沒有甚麼貢獻 / 出力很少**。

So here:

contribute = 為共同工作提供自己的時間、努力、想法或成果

1. **contribute to a team / project — 為團隊 / 項目作出貢獻**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Some employees **contribute very little**.

有些員工**幾乎沒有甚麼貢獻**。

Practice 2

> Everyone is expected to **contribute to the project**.

每個人都應該為項目**作出貢獻**。

Practice 3

> She contributed a great deal to the team's success.

她對團隊的成功**作出了很大貢獻**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribute = 為共同目標提供時間、努力、知識、想法或其他有價值的東西

2. **contribute ideas — 提供想法；貢獻意見**

Practice 1

> Quieter members should also be encouraged to **contribute ideas**.

也應鼓勵較安靜的成員**提出自己的想法**。

Practice 2

> Everyone **contributed ideas** during the meeting.

每個人在會議中都**提供了意見**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribute ideas = 把自己的想法加入共同討論或工作

3. **contribute time / effort — 投入時間 / 努力**

Practice 1

> All members should **contribute time and effort**.

所有成員都應該**投入時間和努力**。

Practice 2

> She contributed more effort than anyone else.

她比任何人都**付出了更多努力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribute time/effort = 把自己的時間或心力投入共同工作

4. **contribute skills / expertise — 貢獻技能 / 專業知識**

Practice 1

> Each person **contributed different skills**.

每個人都**貢獻了不同技能**。

Practice 2

> Engineers and designers **contributed their expertise** to the project.

工程師和設計師把自己的**專業知識投入項目**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contribute skills/expertise = 把自己的能力或專業知識用於共同目標****

5. ****contribute something to something — 把某物貢獻給某事****

A very important grammar pattern.

Practice 1

> She ****contributed several useful suggestions to the discussion****.

她為討論****提出了幾個有用建議****。

Practice 2

> Each department ****contributed staff to the project****.

每個部門都為項目****提供了人手****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contribute X to Y = 把 X 提供給 Y，成為其中一部分****

6. ****contribute (捐款；捐助) — 捐助；捐款****

A major separate sense.

Practice 1

> Many employees ****contributed money**** to the charity.

很多員工都向慈善機構****捐款****。

Practice 2

> Would you like to ****contribute to the fund****?

你願意為這個基金****捐款****嗎？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contribute = 自願提供金錢或物資以支持某個組織、活動或目的****

7. **contribute to a fund — 向基金供款 / 捐款**

Practice 1

> Staff **contribute to a retirement fund** each month.

員工每月向退休基金**供款**。

Practice 2

> Everyone was invited to **contribute to the emergency fund**.

每個人都獲邀向應急基金**捐款**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribute to a fund = 把金錢加入共同基金

8. **contribute to charity — 向慈善機構捐助**

Practice 1

> She regularly **contributes to charity**.

她定期**捐助慈善機構**。

Practice 2

> The company encourages workers to **contribute to local charities**.

公司鼓勵員工**捐助本地慈善機構**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribute to charity = 提供金錢或物資支持慈善用途

9. **contribute (定期供款) — 供款**

A common financial/institutional sense.

Practice 1

> Employees **contribute** five percent of their salary **to** the pension scheme.

員工把薪金的百分之五**供款至**退休金計劃**。**

Practice 2

> Both the employer and employee **contribute**.

僱主和僱員雙方都會**供款**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribute = 定期支付金錢加入退休金、保險或其他共同計劃

10. **contribute to a result / outcome** — 促成結果

A major abstract causal sense.

Practice 1

> Clear communication **contributed to** the project's success.

清晰溝通**促成了**項目成功**。**

Practice 2

> Several factors **contributed to** the improvement.

多個因素共同**促成了**改善**。**

MCQ-ready definition:

contribute to X = 成為造成 X 的其中一個因素

11. **contribute to a problem** — 導致 / 加劇問題

The result can be negative.

Practice 1

> Poor communication **contributed to** the conflict.

溝通不良**促成 / 加劇了**衝突**。**

Practice 2

> Unclear roles can **contribute to confusion**.

角色不清可能**造成混亂**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribute to a problem = 成為問題形成或惡化的其中一個原因

12. **contribute to someone's success / failure — 促成成功 / 失敗**

Practice 1

> Good leadership **contributed to the team's success**.

良好領導**促成了團隊成功**。

Practice 2

> Poor planning **contributed to the failure**.

規劃不善是**導致失敗的因素之一**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribute to success/failure = 對成功或失敗的形成產生部分作用

13. **contributing factor — 促成因素；成因之一**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

> Stress was a **contributing factor** in the argument.

壓力是爭吵的其中一個**促成因素**。

Practice 2

> Poor communication was a major **contributing factor**.

溝通不良是一個主要的**成因**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contributing factor = 有份造成某個結果，但未必是唯一原因的因素****

14. ****contributory factor — 促成因素；成因之一****

Similar to ****contributing factor****, often more formal.

Practice 1

> Fatigue may have been a ****contributory factor****.

疲勞可能是其中一個****促成因素****。

Practice 2

> Several ****contributory factors**** were identified.

調查找出了數個****成因因素****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contributory factor = formal: 對某個結果有部分促成作用的因素****

15. ****contribute an article / piece — 投稿；撰稿****

A distinct publishing/media sense.

Practice 1

> She ****contributes articles to a business magazine****.

她為一本商業雜誌****撰稿****。

Practice 2

> Several experts ****contributed essays to the book****.

數位專家為這本書****撰寫文章****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contribute an article/piece = 為報章、雜誌、書籍或網站提供自己撰寫的內容****

16. **contribute to a newspaper / magazine / website — 為媒體撰稿**

Practice 1

> He regularly **contributes to several newspapers**.

他定期為幾份報章**撰稿**。

Practice 2

> She has **contributed to the website** for several years.

她多年來一直為該網站**提供文章內容**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contribute to a publication = 定期或偶爾為某媒體提供文章、評論或其他內容****

17. **contribution (貢獻 ; 付出) — 貢獻 ; 付出**

Practice 1

> Her **contribution to the team** was significant.

她對團隊的**貢獻**很大。

Practice 2

> Everyone's **contribution** should be visible.

每個人的**貢獻**都應該清楚可見。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contribution = 某人為共同成果加入的工作、想法、時間或價值****

18. **make a contribution — 作出貢獻**

Practice 1

> Everyone should **make a meaningful contribution**.

每個人都應該**作出有意義的貢獻**。

Practice 2

> She made an important **contribution to the discussion**.

她對討論**作出了重要貢獻**。

MCQ-ready definition:

make a contribution = 為某件事加入有用的工作、意見、資源或成果

19. **valuable / significant contribution — 有價值 / 重要的貢獻**

Practice 1

> The quieter employee made a **valuable contribution**.

那名較安靜的員工作出了**有價值的貢獻**。

Practice 2

> His research made a **significant contribution** to the field.

他的研究對該領域作出了**重大貢獻**。

MCQ-ready definition:

valuable/significant contribution = 對成果、知識或發展帶來明顯價值的貢獻

20. **individual contribution — 個人貢獻**

Very relevant to teamwork.

Practice 1

> Managers should evaluate each person's **individual contribution**.

經理應評估每個人的**個人貢獻**。

Practice 2

> Individual contributions were recorded separately.

各人的**個別貢獻**被分開記錄。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****individual contribution = 某一個人在團隊成果中實際加入的部分****

21. ****financial contribution — 金錢貢獻；供款****

Practice 1

> The company made a large ****financial contribution****.

公司作出了大筆****金錢捐助****。

Practice 2

> Members pay a monthly ****contribution****.

會員每月需要繳交****供款****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****financial contribution = 為某個基金、計劃、活動或目的提供的金錢****

22. ****pension contribution — 退休金供款****

Practice 1

> The employer increased its ****pension contributions****.

僱主增加了****退休金供款****。

Practice 2

> Monthly ****pension contributions**** are deducted from salary.

每月的****退休金供款****會從薪金中扣除。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****pension contribution = 定期存入退休金計劃的金錢****

23. ****contribution to society / community — 對社會 / 社區的貢獻****

Practice 1

> Teachers make an important **contribution to society**.

教師對社會作出重要**貢獻**。

Practice 2

> Her work has made a lasting **contribution to the community**.

她的工作對社區作出了長遠的**貢獻**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribution to society = 對社會福祉、知識或發展帶來的正面價值

24. **contribution** (文章 / 投稿) — 投稿 ; 撰稿內容

Practice 1

> Her **contribution to the magazine** appeared last month.

她為雜誌寫的**投稿文章**上月刊登了。

Practice 2

> The editor thanked all the writers for their **contributions**.

編輯感謝所有作者的**投稿**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribution = 為書籍、雜誌、網站等提供的一篇文章或其他內容

25. **contribution** (促成作用) — 促成作用 ; 影響

Practice 1

> The report examined stress's **contribution to poor performance**.

報告研究壓力對表現欠佳的**促成作用**。

Practice 2

> Several factors made a **contribution to the decline**.

多個因素對下滑都有一定的**促成作用**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contribution to a result = 某個因素對結果形成所起的部分作用

26. **contributor (貢獻者) — 貢獻者 ; 參與者**

Practice 1

> She was one of the main **contributors to the project**.

她是項目的主要**貢獻者**之一。

Practice 2

> Every **contributor** received credit.

每位**作出貢獻的人**都獲得肯定。

MCQ-ready definition:

contributor = 為某項工作、成果或活動提供有價值內容的人

27. **contributor (撰稿人) — 撰稿人 ; 投稿者**

Practice 1

> She is a regular **contributor to the magazine**.

她是該雜誌的固定**撰稿人**。

Practice 2

> The website has contributors from several countries.

這個網站有來自多個國家的**撰稿人**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contributor = 定期或偶爾為媒體提供文章、評論或其他內容的人

28. **contributor (捐助者) — 捐助者 ; 供款人**

Practice 1

> Major **contributors** were thanked publicly.

主要**捐助者**獲公開致謝。

Practice 2

> Each **contributor** gave money to the fund.

每位**捐款者**都向基金提供了金錢。

MCQ-ready definition:

contributor = 向基金、慈善或共同計劃提供金錢的人或機構

29. **contributor (成因之一) — 促成因素**

A non-person sense.

Practice 1

> Stress is a major **contributor to burnout**.

壓力是導致倦怠的一個主要**因素**。

Practice 2

> Poor sleep was an important **contributor to the problem**.

睡眠不足是造成問題的重要**因素之一**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contributor = 對某個結果有明顯促成作用的人或因素

30. **contributory negligence — 與有過失 ; 共同過失**

A legal specialist extension worth recognizing.

Practice 1

> The court considered whether there was **contributory negligence**.

法院考慮案件中是否存在**與有過失 / 共同過失**。

Practice 2

> Contributory negligence can affect how damages are assessed.

與有過失可能影響賠償額的評定。

MCQ-ready definition:

contributory negligence = 法律上，受損一方自己的疏忽也有份造成其損失的情況

This is a specialist legal sense, useful mainly for recognition.

Important distinction 1: **contribute** vs **participate**

participate

take part in an activity.

contribute

add something useful to it.

A person can participate without contributing much.

That is exactly the issue in your passage.

> attend every meeting = participate

> research data and provide useful ideas = contribute

Important distinction 2: **contribute** vs **help**

help

very broad: make something easier or better.

contribute

add a part to a shared result.

> help the team

> 幫助團隊

> contribute to the team's work

> 為團隊工作**加入自己的部分**

Important distinction 3: **contribute vs provide**

provide

supply something.

contribute

supply it as part of a wider joint effort.

> provide information

> 提供資料

> contribute information to the report

> 把資料**加入共同報告**

Important distinction 4: **contribute vs donate**

donate

give money, goods, blood, etc., usually for charity/public benefit.

contribute

broader.

You can contribute:

* money,

* effort,

* ideas,

* articles,

* expertise.

All donations are contributions, but not all contributions are donations.

Important distinction 5: **contribute vs give**

give

extremely broad transfer verb.

contribute

suggests what is given becomes part of a shared purpose or result.

> give someone £10

> 給某人十鎊

> contribute £10 to a fund

> 向基金**捐**十鎊

Important distinction 6: **contribute vs add**

add

put something extra into something.

contribute

emphasizes useful participation or causal input.

> add a paragraph

> 加一段文字

> contribute a paragraph to the report

> 為報告**撰寫** / 提供一段內容

Important distinction 7: **contribute to a result vs cause a result**

cause

may imply a more direct causal role.

contribute to

means **be one of several causes**.

> Poor communication caused the mistake.

> 溝通不良造成錯誤。

> Poor communication contributed to the mistake.

> 溝通不良是**促成錯誤的其中一個因素**。

This distinction is very important.

Important distinction 8: **contribute to does not imply a positive result**

You can contribute to:

* success,

* improvement,

* confusion,

* conflict,

* failure,

* pollution.

So:

contribute ≠ automatically “作出正面貢獻”

Context determines whether the effect is positive or negative.

Important distinction 9: **contribute something vs contribute to something**

Direct object:

> contribute **an idea**

> 提供一個想法

To + goal/result:

> contribute **to the discussion**

> 為討論作出貢獻

Both:

> contribute **an idea to the discussion**

提供一個想法加入討論

Important distinction 10: **contribute to + noun / -ing**

Natural:

> contribute to success

> contribute to improving communication

Because **to** here is a preposition.

So:

> contribute to **improving** teamwork 

> contribute to **improve** teamwork  in this structure

Important distinction 11: **contribution vs effort**

Very relevant to your passage.

effort

how much energy/work you put in.

contribution

what useful input you actually add.

Someone might make:

* high effort,

* but limited contribution,

if their work does not help the final outcome much.

Important distinction 12: **contribution vs output**

contribution

your share added to a larger whole.

output

the measurable product/result produced.

> individual contribution

> 個人貢獻

> measurable output

> 可量度產出

Your passage later explicitly wants both to be visible.

Important distinction 13: **contribution vs credit**

contribution

what you actually added.

credit

recognition you receive for it.

A teamwork problem arises when:

> contribution is unequal

> but

> credit is equal.

That contrast is central to this paragraph.

Important distinction 14: **contributor as person vs contributor as cause**

Person:

> a contributor to the magazine

> 雜誌撰稿人

Cause:

> a contributor to stress

> 造成壓力的因素

Same noun, very different referent.

Important distinction 15: **contributing factor vs main cause**

contributing factor

one of several factors.

main cause

the most important causal factor.

So something can contribute without being the primary cause.

Family-extension note

Contribute has one broad semantic core:

add something of your own to a larger whole or outcome

That branches into:

1. **teamwork / shared work**

- * contribute effort
- * contribute ideas
- * contribute expertise

2. **money**

- * contribute to charity
- * pension contribution

3. **causation**

- * contribute to success
- * contribute to conflict
- * contributing factor

4. **writing/media**

- * contribute an article
- * contributor to a magazine

5. **noun forms**

- * contribution
- * individual contribution
- * financial contribution

6. **person/factor**

- * contributor

7. **formal causal adjective**

- * contributory factor
- * contributory negligence

For your passage, the exact branch is:

contribute = provide a useful share of the team's effort and work

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
contribute	貢獻；出力	add useful input
contribute to a team	為團隊作貢獻	teamwork
contribute ideas	提供想法	intellectual input
contribute effort	投入努力	work input
contribute expertise	貢獻專業知識	specialist input
contribute X to Y	把 X 貢獻給 Y	add to whole
contribute money	捐款 / 供款	financial input
contribute to charity	捐助慈善	donation
contribute to a fund	向基金供款	finance
contribute to success	促成成功	causal role
contribute to a problem	導致 / 加劇問題	negative causal role
contributing factor	促成因素	partial cause
contributory factor	促成因素	formal partial cause
contribute an article	投稿 / 撰稿	media
contribution	貢獻；付出	useful input

make a contribution	作出貢獻	contribute	
individual contribution	個人貢獻	one person's share	
financial contribution	金錢貢獻；供款	money	
pension contribution	退休金供款	finance	
contribution to society	對社會的貢獻	social value	
contribution (article)	投稿	written content	
contributor	貢獻者	participant	
contributor (writer)	撰稿人	media	
contributor (donor)	捐助者	finance	
contributor (cause)	促成因素	causation	
contributory negligence	與有過失	legal	

For your original sentence

> In many teams, some employees shoulder most of the burden while others ****contribute very little****.

Here:

****contribute very little** = 某些組員雖然身處團隊之中，但實際提供的工作、努力、想法或成果非常少

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 在很多團隊中，有些員工承擔了大部分重擔，而其他人卻****幾乎沒有甚麼貢獻****。

This creates an important contrast:

- > ****participate**** = 有參與
- > ****put in effort**** = 有付出心力
- > ****contribute**** = ****把有用的東西真正加入團隊成果****
- > ****receive credit**** = 因貢獻而獲得肯定

And that distinction is central to this paragraph: someone may technically ****participate**** in the group while still ****contributing very little****.